



COME AS YOU ARE

The Women's Courtyard is a community-based, women-led, multicultural, and informal framework that supports girls and young women at risk. The organization was established in 2003 with the goal of enabling girls and young women to integrate into the community in a positive and empowering way, by providing them with tools to cope with the social and personal challenges they face.

WHO DO WE SUPPORT?

Girls and young women at risk, ages 13–26, who come from intersecting marginalized backgrounds within Israeli society, including poverty, neglect, social exclusion, first- and second-generation immigrant families, and low socio-economic status.



WHAT DO WE DO?

Guidance and Support: The Women's Courtyard provides assistance and ongoing support to approximately 2,000 at-risk girls and young women each year.

A Safe Space: we are operating physical centers in Haifa and Netanya, with an emphasis on creating a supportive, nonjudgmental environment where participants are heard, seen, and accepted exactly as they are.



Education, Training, and Enrichment: we are offering academic support, preparation for matriculation exams and higher education, including private and group lessons in various subjects, vocational counseling and job readiness support, as well as enrichment activities such as arts, crafts, and music.

Rights Realization: The Women's Courtyard provides information, guidance, and hands-on assistance in navigating governmental systems, including support with the National Insurance Institute, access to legal aid, mediation with banks, debt resolution, employment services, and more.

The Women's Courtyard in Haifa

Established in 2013 in the Hadar neighborhood, the Haifa Courtyard serves as a home for the city's diverse cultural identities: Jewish, Muslim, and Christian; immigrants from the former Soviet Union and Israeli-born participants; girls and young women in a range of life circumstances. The Haifa branch supports about 80 participants each month and 250 annually. They come to the Courtyard to receive a hot meal, find a listening ear, access support in exercising their rights, and take part in therapeutic programs such as an art studio, music studio, therapeutic yoga, and more. Over the years, a group of alumnae has been trained as mentors and now accompany the girls as part of the professional team.

The Women's Courtyard in Netanya

Established in 2013 in the Hefzibah–Vatikim neighborhood, the Netanya Courtyard supports approximately 60 girls and young women each month and around 200 each year. Most participants come from the Ethiopian-Israeli community and face the dual challenges of immigration and economic hardship, which often prevent them from realizing their full potential. The Courtyard offers a safe space, social support, and enrichment activities, with a strong focus on preventing hidden dropout from the education system.

OUR PROJECTS

Professional Support for National Service Programs

The Women's Courtyard is officially recognized by the Ministry of Welfare as a national expert in working with young women at risk. As such, the organization provides professional guidance and support to three out of four state-recognized national service programs and leads the training program for coordinators of these specialized frameworks. These programs serve young people who were unable to enlist in the army or participate in regular national service. Participation in national service grants them significant social rights, such as the opportunity to complete their education—thus expanding their ability to reintegrate into society.

The Women's Courtyard Plus

Since the outbreak of the October 7th events, the need for culturally attuned therapeutic support for at-risk girls and young women has grown significantly. Many report worsening symptoms of anxiety, depression, and post-trauma due to war-related experiences, loss of family members or jobs, and a deep sense of personal and financial insecurity.

In response, we launched The Women's Courtyard Plus: a trauma-informed therapeutic initiative combining psychological care, social support, and a safe space for girls and young women dealing with the emotional consequences of war.

Professional Team: Psychologists, clinical social workers, and art therapists from diverse cultural backgrounds, including Arabic and Russia speaking professionals.

Types of Treatment: Individual and group therapy tailored to the characteristics of complex post-trauma.

Scope of Services: In its first phase, the program will serve 50 girls and young women per week, with room for expansion.

For the first time, trauma-informed emotional care is being delivered within the familiar, community-based space of the Courtyard. Based on years of experience, we know that early therapeutic intervention significantly reduces long-term suffering and promotes healthy, sustainable social and economic integration.

THE WOMEN'S COURTYARD CONTINUES TO SERVE AS A
WARM, INCLUSIVE, AND SAFE HOME FOR HUNDREDS OF
YOUNG WOMEN ACROSS ISRAEL, WITH A DEEP
COMMITMENT TO CREATING MEANINGFUL AND LASTING
SOCIAL CHANGE.